

STAGE SEVEN • HARD SKILLS

FIRSTS

ADAPTATION NOTES

Online vs. in-person format notes for every activity that changes shape

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

BY AYOMIDE AYENI

FIRSTS • Adaptation Notes

Stage Seven • Hard Skills

PURPOSE

Stage Seven mixes heavily individual, tool-based work with a meaningful number of genuinely social exercises (negotiation, delegation, meeting role-play, peer teaching). This document covers every activity across the Session Plan and Group Versions of Key Exercises documents that changes shape between formats.

A few activities in this stage genuinely work better online than in person, notably the Collaborative Spreadsheet (K62), where a shared cloud document with everyone editing simultaneously is arguably a cleaner experience than clustering around one physical laptop. Where a format genuinely has an edge, it's flagged explicitly rather than treating both as equivalent by default.

Format Notes by Activity

Activity	In-Person	Online
Live spreadsheet/data work (K1, K2, K43, K53, K62)	Participants work on personal laptops; facilitator circulates for troubleshooting.	Share screen to demo formulas live before independent work. Keep a co-facilitator available via chat for troubleshooting, since remote participants can't flag a passerby.
Collaborative Spreadsheet (K62)	Small groups share one laptop or work on a shared physical view.	Use a genuinely shared cloud spreadsheet (Google Sheets) with all participants editing simultaneously — this actually works better online than in person for this specific exercise.
Mock Meeting Role-Play (K6, from Group Versions doc)	Groups of 4–5 physically run a short meeting in a breakout area.	Breakout rooms of 4–5. Record the breakout if your platform allows, so the group can review their own meeting dynamics afterward.
Practice Circle presentations (K42, K51)	Small groups present to each other in person, immediate live feedback.	Breakout rooms of 3–4 with screen sharing enabled for any visual aids. Confirm audio quality before starting — presentation exercises are especially sensitive to lag or dropped audio.
Digital Presentation Recording (K34) and on-camera work	Participants step to a quiet corner or hallway to record on their phone.	These work naturally well online since participants are already on camera — have them record locally on their device rather than screen-recording the video call.
Negotiation Exercise (K22) and other role-plays	Pairs face each other directly; body language is part of the practice.	Breakout rooms of 2. Encourage cameras on specifically for this exercise, since tone and non-verbal cues matter genuinely more in negotiation than in most other exercises.
Cross-Functional Collaboration (K25) mixer	Physically mix participants from different backgrounds into small groups.	Use breakout room pre-assignment (not random) to deliberately mix backgrounds, since random online breakouts can't guarantee the same intentional mixing a facilitator can do by walking the room.
Non-Expert Panel (K51, from Group Versions doc)	Invite outside guests to sit in the room as a live audience.	Invite outside guests via video call link for just that segment — online format actually makes it easier to bring in a genuinely external guest who couldn't otherwise travel to the session.
Full-group share-outs and closing rounds	Genuine round-robin around the room.	Use “raise hand” or call names directly from a list rather than open-floor, which tends to stall on video, especially with a group of this potential size.

GENERAL GUIDANCE FOR A STAGE THIS SIZE

Given thirteen sub-sessions, consistency in format matters more here than in shorter stages — switching between online and in-person mid-stage genuinely disrupts the continuity of real datasets, projects, and portfolios participants are meant to carry across sub-sessions.

For hybrid cohorts, the technical, hands-on sections (3, 5) place the heaviest facilitator burden on troubleshooting remote participants — a dedicated co-facilitator for remote support is genuinely worth the resource investment for those sections specifically.